



Record Your IM Video Chat

Learn to record the video chats you've had over instant messengers

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Have you ever wondered if there was some way you could record memorable video chats you've had with your friends or family? What about important video conferences with clients? We have just the software for you!

What You Need

To be able to record your video conferences—irrespective of the chat client you are using—you need to download a free utility called 'Bulent's Screen Recorder'. Download '1.5b', the freeware version from <http://snipurl.com/evp8>.

At www.silver.net, you can find the latest, paid version of the software.

1 Startup

Starting the software after installation will get you to the default window, and the default settings are more or less sufficient for most recordings.



Default screen of Bulent's Screen Recorder

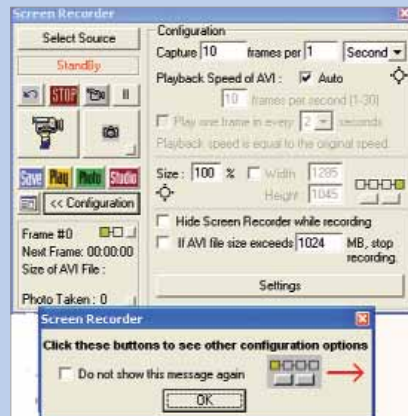
2 Configuration

The software offers a pretty comprehensive list of tweaks for your recordings.

Click on the configuration button, and you will be presented with a rather haphazard configuration window where you can manage the various settings for your recordings.

The default capture quality is set at 10 frames per second (fps), which you should change to the value you would like—most movies are encoded at 30 fps.

Apart from the capture rate, it also lets you select the compression you want to use, as well as set the compression rate using a simple slider. You can also set hotkeys to take screenshots, and set a file size limit for recording—wherein the recording will stop as and when the file size is reached.

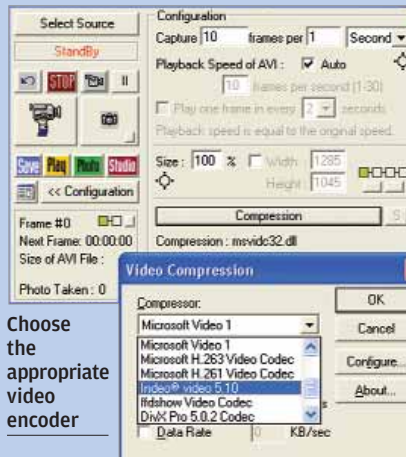


Change the settings in Configuration Panel

3 Recording

First of all, you need to choose the source from which you will record. Click the 'Select Source' button on top, and then select from amongst the options of 'Entire desktop', 'A full window'—which can be any open window on your desktop, 'A specific region' which can be set by you, or your handycam.

The last mode, 'Watch it', puts the software into a monitoring mode and will start recording when a change



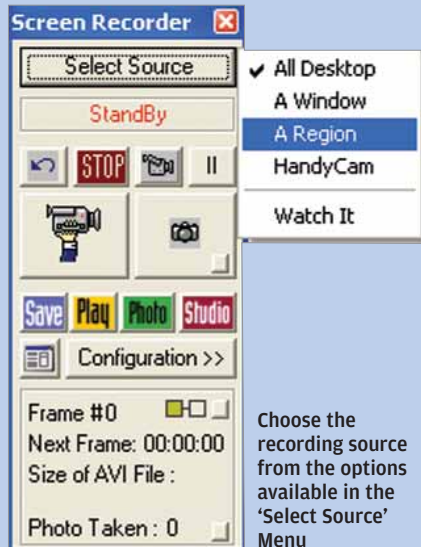
Choose the appropriate video encoder

occurs in the source. It will otherwise pause and wait for any change in the scene. This is great for security related capturing—as soon as someone enters an otherwise empty room, the software detects the scene change and starts recording.

To record video chats, select the source as 'A full window', set window as MSN or Yahoo! video chat window.

4 Continuous Recording

Once the source has been selected, you can start recording by clicking on the handycam button. This is the manual record and you need to keep the button pressed (by holding down the mouse button) to keep recording. The moment you release the button, it will stop recording. To keep recording continuously, you should first click



Choose the recording source from the options available in the 'Select Source' Menu

the handycam button, and then click the arrow on the top left. This will make your recording continuous until you press the 'Stop' button.

5 Playback

On pressing the 'Stop' button, you will be provided with various options of 'Save', 'Play', 'Photo', or 'Studio', the last of which lets you edit your AVI file. Clicking 'Play' will open your default AVI player and play the file.

6 Image Capturing

The button next to the handycam button that looks like a still camera is just that! Once you stop your recording, you can view these snapshots by clicking on the green button labeled 'photo'.

That's all there is to it. You can now have video chat logs and say goodbye to boring old text—provided you have broadband, of course!

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